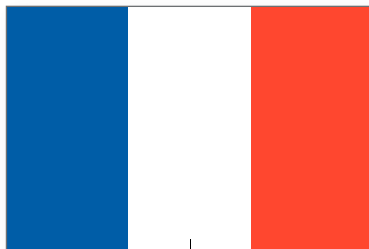


France

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** February 15, 1794 **Usage:** National and Civil

Red, white, and blue have come to represent liberty, equality, and fraternity—the ideals of the French Revolution



Blue and red are the colors of Paris

White is the color of the House of Bourbon

Europe



France was a monarchy until the the Revolution of 1789. A republic was created in 1792, following the abolition of the monarchy.

The traditional emblem of France was the *fleur-de-lis*, or lily, which first appeared on the arms in the 12th century.

A REVOLUTIONARY FLAG

The *Tricolore* was used during the Revolution and has since become a symbol of liberty around the world.

Other nations have also adopted the design. Because France has no arms, the *Tricolore* is also the national emblem.

The colors are probably derived from those of Paris, combined with those of the Bourbon Dynasty, though they are usually associated with liberty, equality, and fraternity.

Overseas Territories



ST. PIERRE & MIQUELON

These islands lie just south of Canada's Newfoundland. The flag features the emblems of the Basques, Bretons, and Normans who settled the islands.



FRENCH POLYNESIA

Red and white are local colors. The emblem depicts a *pirogue*—a local canoe—below a rising sun. The five crew recall the five island groups.